

Michelle Rumbidzai Gaswa

SOMMELIER

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Results-driven Sommelier with over 5 years of experience in luxury hospitality and fine dining environments. Skilled in curating dynamic wine lists, delivering engaging wine tastings, and creating thoughtful food and wine pairings that enhance guest experiences and drive revenue growth. Strong background in wine education, guest relations, and premium service delivery, with a passion for sharing wine knowledge and creating memorable hospitality experiences.

EXPERIENCE

Sommelier

OCT 2023 — PRESENT

Constantia Uitsig Wine Estate

- Contributed to the planning of wine events and tasting menus, helping create structured guest experiences that showcased the estate's wine selection.
- Led guided tastings, vintage comparisons, and barrel tastings for guests and wine club members, translating wine knowledge into engaging, memorable experiences.
- Supported wine farm tasting events and wine club activities, strengthening guest engagement and reinforcing the estate's brand story.
- Provided informed wine recommendations across the farm restaurants to enhance food and wine pairings and elevate the dining experience.
- Supported wine club sign-ups and package sales through personalised upselling and attentive guest service across multiple estate outlets.

Wine Waiter

JAN 2020 — NOV 2023

Hillcrest Wine Farm

- Drove a 25% increase in wine club sign-ups through personalized guest engagement, relationship building, and tailored wine recommendations.
- Improved tasting room conversion and buying rates by delivering attentive service and guiding guests toward premium wine selections.
- Delivered curated tastings and exclusive tasting events that strengthened guest loyalty and supported repeat sales.
- Educated guests on wine appreciation, tasting techniques, grape varieties, and food and wine pairing principles in an approachable, engaging manner.
- Collaborated with the chef to curate wine lists and seasonal tasting menus aligned with the restaurant and cellar offering.
- Applied effective upselling and cross-selling techniques to maximize customer spend and improve sales performance.
- Maintained in-depth knowledge of wines, vintages, producers, and industry trends to provide informed recommendations to guests.

Waitress

NOV 2017 — OCT 2019

Blockhouse Kitchen

- Delivered warm, professional front-of-house service that helped create a positive first impression and a welcoming guest experience.
- Managed guest flow, reservations, and seating arrangements to support smooth operations during busy service periods.
- Worked closely with service and kitchen teams to resolve guest requests efficiently and maintain high service standards.

EDUCATION

WSET Level 2 in Wines

2023-10 – 2023-10

Diploma in Hospitality Management

2020-02 – 2023-08

SKILLS

- Wine Expertise
- Food & Wine Pairing
- Customer Service Excellence
- Wine Sales & Upselling
- Wine Tasting & Guided Tastings
- Wine List Curation
- Communication & Storytelling

CERTIFICATIONS

WSET Level 2 in Wines
· 2023

HOSPITALITY PROFILE

Wine knowledge Intermediate